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## MACRON BEGINS THREE-DAY VISIT TO BRITAIN

■ Britain's King Charles III and France's President Emmanuel Macron travel in the 1902 State Landau carriage during a procession at Windsor Castle, in Windsor, west of London, yesterday. The French President began a three-day state visit to Britain yesterday, which will see him address parliament and try to rekindle a purportedly warm relationship with the British monarch.

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## UAE surpasses US in supertall skyscrapers

Dubai leads the boom in high-rises as country ranks second

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The UAE has officially surpassed the United States in the number of completed skyscrapers exceeding 300 metres in height, according to newly released data from the Council on Tall Buildings and Urban Habitat (CTBUH).

The UAE now boasts 37 buildings taller than 300 metres, edging past the United States, which has 31. China, however, remains far ahead

37  
buildings taller than  
300 metres are  
currently in UAE

with 122 supertall structures, reinforcing its dominance in global high-rise construction.

Dubai leads the UAE's skyscraper boom and is home to the Burj Khalifa, the world's tallest building at 828 metres. The city's skyline has become a symbol of the nation's drive for leadership in architecture, innovation, and tourism.

Across all height categories, the UAE now ranks third globally, with 345 buildings over 150 metres and 159 above 200 metres.

China dominates

Meanwhile, China continues to dominate the global skyline. The country has 3,497 buildings taller than 150 metres, 1,271 over 200 metres, and 122 exceeding 300 metres. Other nations like Malaysia, Japan, South Korea, Canada, and Australia are also expanding their high-rise portfolios, as they follow China, UAE and the US, which currently ranks second in total tall buildings, with 909 structures above 150 metres.

## Trump upbeat on Gaza deal amid truce talks

MEDIATOR QATAR SAYS MEETINGS ARE FOCUSED ON 'FRAMEWORK' FOR TALKS

DOHA

■ Indirect Gaza ceasefire talks resumed yesterday in Qatar, while Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu visited Washington to meet US President Donald Trump, who expressed optimism about a possible breakthrough.

Qatar, a mediator along with the United States and Egypt, said the meetings were focused on a "framework" for the talks.

"Indirect negotiations are continuing this morning in Doha, with a fourth meeting being held ... the discussions are still focused on the mechanisms for implementation, particularly the clauses related to withdrawal and humanitarian aid," a Palestinian official close to the talks told AFP. "No breakthrough has been achieved so far, and the negotiations are ongoing," another Palestinian official said.

Deadly day for Israel

On the ground, five Israeli soldiers were killed in combat in northern Gaza — one of the deadliest days this year for Israeli forces in the Palestinian territory.

Israel and Hamas began the latest round of negotiations on Sunday, with representatives seated in separate rooms within the same building.

Netanyahu's trip to Washington is his third visit since Trump's return to office. On Monday, Trump expressed confidence a deal could be reached.

"I don't think there is a hold-

● **Sitting across from Netanyahu at the White House, Trump said Hamas was willing to end the Gaza conflict, now entering its 22nd month.**

up. I think things are going along very well," Trump told reporters when asked what was preventing an agreement.

Sitting across from Netanyahu at the White House, Trump said Hamas was willing to end the Gaza conflict, now entering its 22nd month.

"They want to meet and they want to have that ceasefire," Trump said when asked if ongoing clashes would derail talks.

Trump's special envoy Steve Witkoff was set to join the talks in Doha this week.

An Israeli official accompanying Netanyahu to Washington said the proposal under discussion was "80-90 per cent of what Israel wanted."

"I believe that with military and political pressure, all the hostages can be returned," the official told Israeli media.

According to Ariel Kahana of *Israel Hayom* daily, "President Trump and his advisers are currently exerting considerable effort to reach an agreement that would lead to the release of the hostages and could even end the war in Gaza."

— AFP  
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